



27 BCE

ROME'S FIRST EMPEROR

Julius Caesar's adoptive son Octavian had defeated his rivals in a civil war by 31 BCE. Rather than restore the Roman Republic, he accepted extensive powers from the Senate, and the titles of *Augustus* ("illustrious") and *princeps* ("the first"), becoming the first emperor. He conquered parts of Central Europe, rebuilt much of Rome, and bequeathed his position to his stepson Tiberius in 14 CE.

▷ **Augustus of Prima Porta**, Roman copy of a bronze original

"He could justly boast that he had found it built of brick and left it in marble."

SUETONIUS, LIVES OF THE TWELVE CAESARS, 121 CE, ON AUGUSTUS'S LEGACY

30 BCE

23 BCE The Romans invade Meroë, south-east Egypt, sacking its capital Napata

c. 25 BCE

BUDDHIST CANON IS FIRST WRITTEN DOWN IN SRI LANKA

The teachings of the Buddha, who lived in the 6th century BCE, were passed down orally by his followers for generations. As the religion spread from its north Indian homeland, the need for a written version grew. In around 25 BCE, the scriptures, including theological analysis and rules for monks, were set down in Sri Lanka in a collection known as the Tripitaka or Pali Canon (from the language in which they were written).

▷ **Pages of the Pali Canon**

